

Cybercrime Case Study — Identity Theft

Identity theft is a cybercrime in which a person's personal information, such as Aadhaar number, PAN details, or banking data, is stolen and misused for financial or fraudulent activities. It is becoming increasingly common with the growth of digital platforms.

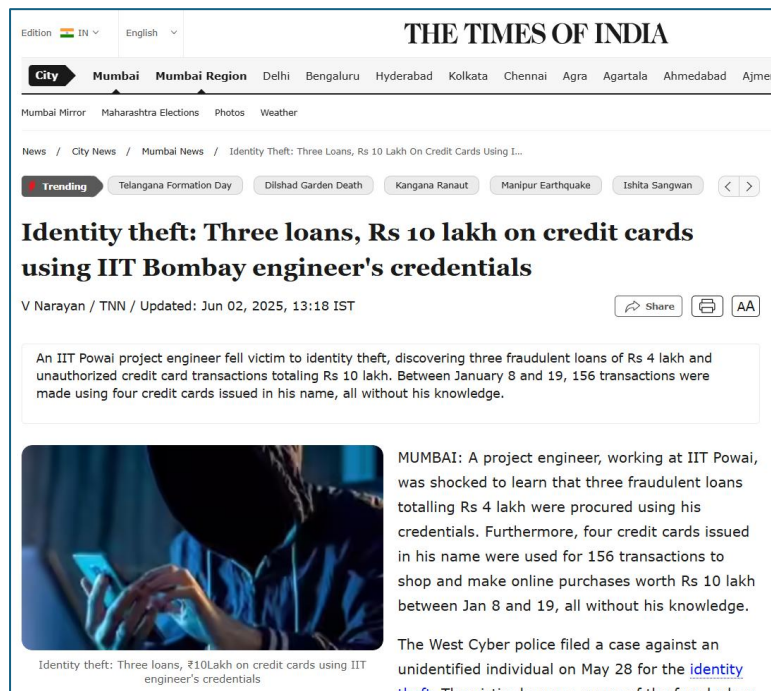
A real case involved an engineer in Mumbai who discovered that multiple loans and credit cards had been issued in his name without his knowledge. Fraudsters had somehow obtained his personal documents and used them to apply for loans and perform over 150 online transactions. The victim only realized the fraud when he started receiving calls from financial institutions asking for loan repayments.

Typically, identity theft happens in several steps. First, the attacker collects personal information through data leaks, phishing emails, or social media. Then, they use this information to create fake accounts or apply for financial services. Finally, they carry out transactions or fraud, leaving the victim unaware until damage is already done.

Such crimes usually target students, working professionals, or anyone who shares personal data online without caution. The consequences can be serious, including financial loss, damage to credit score, legal complications, and mental stress.

This case highlights the importance of protecting personal information and regularly monitoring financial activity to detect suspicious actions early.

Source & Inspiration:



This case study is inspired by a real identity theft incident reported in The Times of India, where an individual's personal information was misused to obtain loans and perform unauthorized transactions. The case highlights how easily personal data can be exploited if not properly protected

What Happened in the Original Case:

In the real case, a Mumbai-based engineer became a victim of identity theft when fraudsters used his personal information to take multiple loans and credit cards without his knowledge.

They used his details to:

- apply for loans
- issue credit cards
- perform many financial transactions

The victim only found out when:

- banks started calling him for repayments

This showed that his identity had been misused for a long time without his awareness.